

Chapter 120_2 - Xuanyuan

Bai Lin¹, who had been hiding in Chu Qingqiu's pocket, also fell out at this time. Its four paws scrambled on the ground, and the heavy white tiger was blown away like a cotton ball.

Fortunately, Ning Fuyi reacted quickly, grabbed its tail, and tucked it under her arm.

Bai Lin seemed to have been stunned by the sound, hanging limply with all four limbs, its eyes rolled back.

"This wind is too strange. Who knows when it will stop, and there's no place to take shelter here," Ning Fuyi couldn't even hear her own words. "Miasma above and fierce winds below - this doesn't look like any ancient kingdom, but rather an excellent trap!"

She tried to form arrays and create barriers, but no matter how strong the barriers were, they could only touch the ground for an instant before quickly disappearing.

This place was too strange, as if something invisible was affecting them, making all formations useless.

Chu Qingqiu read her lips to understand what she said, then her eyes widened and she gestured: "The rocks are moving!"

Ning Fuyi looked up and indeed saw that several rocks that had been in front of them had quietly changed positions, forming two paths extending deep into the desert. The paths were filled with wind and sand, with no visible end.

"What should we do? We have four people - should we walk together or split up?" Jiuying had recovered some strength and was now standing, sending out red light to resist the fierce wind. "We can't just wait here forever - more wind is coming from behind."

She was right. Behind them, wind and sand rushed toward them like giant beasts, so high they merged with the miasma, seeming to force them forward.

"I think this cursed place wants to scatter our forces. We should still walk together - let's see where we can get!" Ning Fuyi said, then pointed to the right path, indicating they should go that way.

"Alright, let's split up!" Jiuying waved at her.

Ning Fuyi was startled, then remembered that Jiuying still had cloth stuffed in her ears. Just as she was about to repeat it mentally, the fierce wind from behind had already arrived, instantly blowing everything into darkness. She stumbled unsteadily and stepped into the right stone crevice, grabbing someone tightly in her panic and pulling them to her side.

But that person pushed her away and scolded: "Ning Fuyi, look clearly at who I am!"

Ning Fuyi squinted to see - it was Qiu Yi staring at her with wide eyes. Ning Fuyi immediately stepped back and put her hands behind her back.

Qiu Yi was obviously also very embarrassed. As the wind gradually subsided, she gripped her twin blades and said nothing more.

Ning Fuyi quickly used their contract to communicate with Jiuying: "Are you with Divine Venerable?"

The other side quickly replied: "Of course!"

Ning Fuyi breathed a sigh of relief while also finding it both funny and exasperating. She cursed mentally: "I said to walk together, but you insisted on splitting up. Do we really have such poor coordination?"

"My ears are blocked and I can't read lips - how would I know what you're saying?" Jiuying cursed back. "Hurry up and go. Your Divine Venerable is very reliable, blocking all the wind and sand for me. We've already walked half the path."

"You're not allowed to get close to her..." Ning Fuyi had only said half her sentence when the other side went silent. She could only angrily withdraw her thoughts and grip her Emei thorns².

"Let's go," she said to Qiu Yi.

The shrill wailing had diminished considerably. Even without blocking their hearing, they were no longer affected. Ning Fuyi picked up Bai Lin and shook it awake, then threw it into a memory bead³. Then the two of them and one tiger proceeded along the path piled with rocks.

After walking just a few steps, the path behind them was disrupted by rocks, yet neither of them had heard any sound of rocks moving.

"This place is truly eerie. It seems beyond human capability to create," Ning Fuyi spoke to break the silence, her body covered in sand and dust, though she was too lazy to brush it off.

"Xuanyuan Kingdom," Qiu Yi suddenly said. When Ning Fuyi looked at her, she said quietly, "The land has a spirit. Perhaps this ancient kingdom rejects all invaders."

Ning Fuyi nodded as she looked at her: "It must be so."

Qiu Yi suddenly shivered. When she met Ning Fuyi's questioning gaze, she gripped her twin blades tightly.

She said softly: "I also feel it - like someone is watching us."

Ning Fuyi felt a chill from her tone, so she looked back and surveyed their surroundings, then nodded: "Alright, let's hurry. The wind and sand are coming again."

Ning Fuyi could feel that the further they walked, the more towering the surrounding rocks became, like countless giant serpents lined up in a row, flicking their tongues as they looked down at the two of them.

"Ning Fuyi!" Qiu Yi suddenly spoke, moving closer to her. "I'm a little scared."

Ning Fuyi paused and turned to look at her, her eyes dark and unclear: "Oh?"

"Shall we walk together?" Qiu Yi said again, extending her slender hand toward Ning Fuyi while shrinking back.

Ning Fuyi looked at her for a long moment, then curved her lips: "Sure."

However, just as their fingertips were about to touch Qiu Yi, she suddenly flashed through the void, and the Emei thorns in her hand immediately extended from the ring, gleaming coldly in the dim gloom.

At the same time, "Qiu Yi" also swung her long blade to strike at her. The Emei thorns collided with her long blade, shocking Ning Fuyi's right hand numb. She immediately threw out the Emei thorns, leaning back to dodge another whistling blade, silently chanting something. Pink heavenly thunder immediately fell from overhead, striking a ravine where "Qiu Yi" was standing.

But "Qiu Yi's" figure twisted like a snake to her side, the long blade stabbing toward her heart again. Ning Fuyi's brow furrowed sternly, immediately reaching out to block her wrist. The pain made her red lips press tightly together, then she caught the Emei thorns from mid-air and accurately stabbed them into "Qiu Yi's" heart.

Instantly like a rice sack with a leak, the woman's originally tall and well-proportioned body quickly deflated, finally falling into a human skin bag, collapsing on the ground.

Ning Fuyi rubbed her reddened hand on her arm, breathing in as she leaned closer, using her foot to poke at the human skin bag. Though the features were distorted, she could see it was a young girl, not Qiu Yi.

She breathed a sigh of relief, but couldn't help feeling a chill enter her body. If this human skin also belonged to an intruder, then Qiu Yi was now missing...

She shook her head, not daring to think further. But the path back had been completely disrupted by rocks, making it impossible to determine direction.

Moreover, under this miasma, each use of immortal power would draw miasma into her body. She had only summoned one heavenly thunder, but now felt her limbs growing heavy.

"Jiuying!" She again connected through their contract. "Go ask Chu Qingqiu a question - where was our first kiss?"

After a moment, Jiuying's voice came through with laughter: "Divine Venerable asks if I've gone crazy."

Ning Fuyi paused, almost ready to curse: "Not you - me! Ask her where she and Ning Fuyi first kissed!"

After another moment of silence in her mind, Jiuying spoke again: "Divine Venerable told you to get lost."

Hearing this, Ning Fuyi breathed a sigh of relief - this was definitely Chu Qingqiu. Then she said in a low voice: "Qiu Yi is missing."

The volume on the other side immediately increased: "What?! Isn't she with you?"

"It was a human skin bag, transformed to look like Qiu Yi, so it had human aura and was hard to detect," Ning Fuyi looked behind her. "Now I don't know where Qiu Yi is."

"Wait a moment - Divine Venerable says she's coming over," Jiuying said, and the connection between them abruptly ended.

At the same time, a long wind howled, and the surrounding giant rocks turned to powder one by one, like rolling thunder. The pulverized dust mixed with miasma struck their faces - if Ning Fuyi hadn't quickly covered herself with her sleeve, she might have been beaten like a sieve.

When she opened her eyes again, Chu Qingqiu had appeared at the end of the path with an aura of cold, behind her the devastation of countless shattered rocks, while she remained clean without even a speck of dust.

Her face was pale from using too much immortal power, but her figure showed no signs of swaying. After finding Ning Fuyi, she strode over: "Where did she disappear?"

In her shock, Ning Fuyi pointed behind herself: "When we just separated, that Qiu Yi was still her, but later she was silently replaced by the human skin bag. It must have been halfway through our journey."

"I don't know what power took her away - I didn't notice at all," Ning Fuyi gripped her Emei thorns tightly.

"Qiu Yi!" Jiuying ran over following the shattered rocks, shouting into the wind and sand several times, but only the shrill crying came back - no response.

"What should we do? This cursed place has so many troubles," Jiuying immediately cursed.

"Use less immortal power - this miasma will seep into your body," Ning Fuyi advised, then pointed to the human skin bag lying on the ground, her expression worried. "This should also belong to an intruder. I suspect something will suck away people's flesh and blood, leaving only skin."

"Then isn't Qiu Yi in trouble?" Jiuying was somewhat anxious.

Footnotes:

1. **Bai Lin (白麟)** - Chu Qingqiu's white tiger companion that can transform between sizes
2. **Emei thorns (峨眉刺)** - Ning Fuyi's signature weapon, ring-like thorns that can extend and transform
3. **Memory bead (一念珠)** - A magical storage device that can hold living creatures temporarily